

Microsoft Office

Keyboard Shortcuts Guide

Word • Excel • PowerPoint

PRODUCTIVITY HANDBOOK 2026

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A practical reference guide for students, professionals, freelancers, and business owners who want to work faster and smarter. Each shortcut includes a keyboard combination, a clear description, and a real-world use case so you can apply it immediately.

■ Microsoft Word

File Management • Editing • Formatting • Navigation • Selection • Productivity

■ Microsoft Excel

Navigation • Editing • Selection • Formatting • Formulas • Productivity

■ PowerPoint

Presentation • Slides • Editing • Objects • Productivity

Microsoft Word

Document creation, editing, and formatting shortcuts



Master these shortcuts to write and format documents faster — from creating reports and letters to editing and navigating long documents without ever leaving the keyboard.

★ Most Useful Word Shortcuts

Ctrl + Z	Undo your last action instantly
Ctrl + B / I / U	Bold, Italic, Underline selected text
Ctrl + C / V / X	Copy, Paste, Cut — the holy trinity
Ctrl + H	Find & Replace text throughout doc
Ctrl + S	Save — use this constantly!
Ctrl + Enter	Insert a page break

FILE MANAGEMENT

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + N	New document	Start a fresh report or letter
Ctrl + O	Open document	Quickly open a saved project
Ctrl + S	Save document	Save progress after every section
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save As	Save a copy with a different name
Ctrl + W	Close document	Close finished file without exiting Word
Ctrl + P	Print	Send a contract or report to printer
Ctrl + Z	Undo	Reverse an accidental deletion
Ctrl + Y	Redo	Re-apply an undone formatting change

EDITING

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + X	Cut selected text	Move a paragraph to another section
Ctrl + C	Copy selected text	Duplicate a template block
Ctrl + V	Paste	Insert copied content at cursor
Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste Special	Paste without carrying source formatting
Ctrl + F	Find text	Locate a specific word in a long report
Ctrl + H	Find & Replace	Rename a client's name throughout
Ctrl + A	Select all	Select entire document to reformat
Delete	Delete character right	Remove one character at a time
Backspace	Delete character left	Fix a typo immediately
Ctrl + Backspace	Delete previous word	Remove the last word quickly
Ctrl + Delete	Delete next word	Clean up extra words fast

FORMATTING

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + B	Bold	Emphasise a heading or key term
Ctrl + I	Italic	Cite a book title or foreign phrase
Ctrl + U	Underline	Highlight an important deadline
Ctrl + E	Centre align	Centre a document title
Ctrl + L	Left align	Return body text to default alignment
Ctrl + R	Right align	Align a date in a letter header
Ctrl + J	Justify	Give a formal report a polished look
Ctrl +]	Increase font size	Quickly enlarge selected heading
Ctrl + [	Decrease font size	Shrink oversized pasted text
Ctrl + D	Font dialog box	Fine-tune font, size & effects
Ctrl + Shift + C	Copy formatting	Copy heading style to another line
Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste formatting	Apply copied style to new text
Ctrl + Space	Clear character formatting	Strip bold/italic from selected text
Ctrl + 1	Single line spacing	Compact a dense report
Ctrl + 2	Double line spacing	Format an academic essay
Ctrl + 5	1.5 line spacing	Comfortable reading for proposals

NAVIGATION

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + Home	Jump to document start	Quickly return to top of a long doc
Ctrl + End	Jump to document end	Go to the last page immediately
Ctrl + Right	Move word by word right	Navigate text without the mouse
Ctrl + Left	Move word by word left	Quickly reposition cursor
Ctrl + Down	Next paragraph	Hop between paragraphs
Ctrl + G	Go To page/section	Jump to page 47 in a long manual
F5	Open Go To dialog	Navigate to a specific heading
Ctrl + F6	Switch between open docs	Compare two documents side by side

SELECTION

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Shift + Arrows	Extend selection	Precisely highlight text character by character
Ctrl + Shift + End	Select to doc end	Select all text from cursor to finish
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Select to doc start	Select from cursor back to beginning
F8	Extend selection mode	Enter anchor-select mode for large blocks
Ctrl + Click	Select non-contiguous text	Select multiple separate phrases to format

PRODUCTIVITY

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + K	Insert hyperlink	Add a website link inside a proposal
Alt + Shift + D	Insert current date	Auto-stamp today's date in a letter
Ctrl + Shift + N	Apply Normal style	Reset a heading back to body text
F7	Spell check	Check a finished document before sending
Shift + F7	Thesaurus	Find a stronger word quickly
Ctrl + Enter	Page break	Force a new page for Chapter 2
Ctrl + Shift + 8	Show/hide formatting marks	Debug spacing and paragraph issues
Alt + F4	Close Word	Exit the application cleanly

■ **PRO TIP:** Use **Ctrl + Shift + V** to paste text without formatting — a lifesaver when copying from websites or emails.

Microsoft Excel

Data entry, formulas, navigation, and analysis shortcuts



Whether you're building financial models, cleaning datasets, or creating dashboards, these shortcuts will dramatically speed up your Excel workflow and reduce mouse use.

★ Most Useful Excel Shortcuts

Ctrl + Arrows	Jump to the edge of data in any direction
Ctrl + Shift + L	Toggle filters on/off for a dataset
Alt + =	AutoSum a range of numbers instantly
Ctrl + 1	Open Format Cells dialog for full control
F4	Lock cell reference (\$A\$1) in a formula
Ctrl + T	Convert data to a smart Excel Table

FILE & NAVIGATION

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + N	New workbook	Start a fresh financial model
Ctrl + O	Open workbook	Load last month's report
Ctrl + S	Save	Save after every formula change
Ctrl + W	Close workbook	Close one sheet without exiting Excel
Ctrl + Home	Go to cell A1	Reset view to the top-left
Ctrl + End	Go to last used cell	Find the extent of your data
Ctrl + Arrows	Jump to data edge	Skip to last row / column of data
Ctrl + G / F5	Go To dialog	Jump to a named range or cell
Ctrl + Tab	Switch workbooks	Toggle between open files
Ctrl + Page Down	Next worksheet	Move through monthly tabs quickly
Ctrl + Page Up	Previous worksheet	Go back to the previous sheet

EDITING & DATA

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
F2	Edit cell	Edit a formula in place
Ctrl + D	Fill Down	Copy formula from the cell above
Ctrl + R	Fill Right	Copy formula from the cell to the left
Ctrl + ;	Insert today's date	Stamp entry date in a log
Ctrl + Shift + ;	Insert current time	Record exact time of an event
Ctrl + '	Copy formula from above	Repeat same formula without retyping
Ctrl + -	Delete cells/rows/cols	Remove blank rows from a dataset
Ctrl + Shift + +	Insert cells/rows/cols	Add a new row between existing data
Ctrl + Z	Undo	Reverse an accidental delete
Ctrl + Y	Redo	Re-apply an undone paste
Delete	Clear cell contents	Wipe a value without deleting the cell
Ctrl + H	Find & Replace	Fix a recurring wrong value throughout
Ctrl + F	Find	Locate a specific entry quickly

SELECTION

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + Shift + End	Select to last used cell	Select entire data range for copying
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Select to A1	Select all data from current cell back
Ctrl + Shift + Arrows	Extend to data edge	Select a full column of numbers
Ctrl + Space	Select entire column	Highlight a column to format or delete
Shift + Space	Select entire row	Highlight a row to move or delete
Ctrl + A	Select all	Select all data for copy or formatting
Ctrl + Shift + O	Select cells with comments	Review all annotated cells at once

FORMATTING

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + 1	Format Cells dialog	Access all formatting in one place
Ctrl + B	Bold	Emphasise a total row
Ctrl + I	Italic	Italicise a note or label
Ctrl + Shift + \$	Currency format	Format revenue figures as £/\$ quickly
Ctrl + Shift + %	Percentage format	Display growth rates as percentages
Ctrl + Shift + #	Date format	Format a date column properly
Ctrl + Shift + !	Number with commas	Add thousands separator to large values
Alt + H + H	Fill (background) colour	Colour-code categories in a table
Alt + H + B	Add borders	Add grid lines to a report table

FORMULAS

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
=SUM()	Sum a range	Total a column of sales figures
=AVERAGE()	Average a range	Find mean monthly spend
=IF()	Conditional logic	Flag overdue invoices in a list
=VLOOKUP()	Vertical lookup	Match product codes to prices
=INDEX(MATCH())	Flexible lookup	Look up values in any direction
=COUNTIF()	Count with condition	Count how many sales exceed £1000
=SUMIF()	Sum with condition	Total sales for a specific region
Ctrl + `	Show / hide formulas	Audit all formulas on the sheet
F4	Toggle absolute reference	Lock a cell reference as \$A\$1
Alt + =	AutoSum	Instantly sum a selected range
Shift + F3	Insert Function dialog	Browse and insert any function
Ctrl + Shift + Enter	Array formula	Enter a multi-cell array formula

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Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Alt + F1	Insert embedded chart	Quickly visualise selected data
F11	Insert chart on new sheet	Create a standalone sales chart
Ctrl + T	Create table	Format data as a smart Excel table
Ctrl + Shift + L	Toggle filters	Add/remove dropdown filters
Alt + A + T	Apply filter	Filter a dataset by criteria
F4	Repeat last action	Apply same format to multiple cells
Ctrl + K	Insert hyperlink	Link to a source document
Alt + F8	Macro dialog	Run a recorded macro
Ctrl + F2	Print Preview	Check layout before printing

■ **PRO TIP:** Press **Ctrl + `** (backtick) to toggle formula view — see all formulas at once to audit a spreadsheet.

Microsoft PowerPoint

Slide creation, design, and presentation delivery shortcuts



Create polished presentations faster and deliver them with confidence. These shortcuts cover building slides, arranging objects, formatting text, and controlling your slideshow live.

★ Most Useful PowerPoint Shortcuts

F5	Start the slideshow from the first slide
Shift + F5	Start slideshow from the current slide
Ctrl + D	Duplicate a slide or object instantly
Ctrl + G	Group selected objects together
B / W	Black / White screen during presentation
Number + Enter	Jump to any slide number in slideshow

FILE & PRESENTATION

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + N	New presentation	Start a fresh pitch deck
Ctrl + O	Open presentation	Load an existing deck
Ctrl + S	Save	Save after adding each slide
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save As	Save a copy for a client
F5	Start slideshow from start	Launch a full presentation
Shift + F5	Start from current slide	Test a specific section
Ctrl + P	Print	Print speaker notes or handouts
Escape	Exit slideshow	Return to editing mode
B	Black screen (in show)	Pause audience attention
W	White screen (in show)	Clear the screen between topics

SLIDE MANAGEMENT

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + M	New slide	Add a slide for the next topic
Ctrl + D	Duplicate slide	Copy a slide layout to reuse
Ctrl + Shift + D	Duplicate selected object	Copy a graphic element
Ctrl + Shift + Up	Move slide up	Reorder slides in the panel
Ctrl + Shift + Down	Move slide down	Reorder slides in the panel
Ctrl + Z	Undo	Undo an accidental deletion
Ctrl + Y	Redo	Reapply a formatting change
Page Up / Down	Previous / next slide	Navigate slides while editing
Home / End	First / last slide	Jump to beginning or end

EDITING & FORMATTING

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + B	Bold	Emphasise a key stat or number
Ctrl + I	Italic	Italicise a quote or source
Ctrl + U	Underline	Highlight a critical term
Ctrl + E	Centre text	Centre a title on the slide
Ctrl + L	Left-align text	Align bullet points neatly
Ctrl +]	Increase font size	Make a headline larger
Ctrl + [	Decrease font size	Shrink crowded text
Ctrl + G	Group objects	Group icons with text labels
Ctrl + Shift + G	Ungroup objects	Edit one part of a grouped graphic
Ctrl + K	Insert hyperlink	Link a slide to an external report
Ctrl + Shift + C	Copy formatting	Copy text style to another text box

OBJECT ALIGNMENT & ARRANGEMENT

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Tab	Select next object	Cycle through all objects on a slide
Shift + Tab	Select previous object	Navigate objects in reverse
Arrow keys	Nudge object	Fine-position a logo or icon
Shift + Arrows	Nudge in larger steps	Move an object a bigger distance
Ctrl + Shift + H	Align horizontally	Line up multiple elements
Ctrl + Shift + E	Centre on slide	Centre an image perfectly
Ctrl + F	Send to front	Bring an object above others
Ctrl + Shift + F	Bring forward	Layer objects in correct order
Ctrl + Shift + B	Send backward	Push an element behind another

PRODUCTIVITY

Shortcut	What It Does	Real-World Use Case
Ctrl + A	Select all objects	Select everything on a slide
Ctrl + C / V / X	Copy / Paste / Cut	Standard content operations
Ctrl + Z	Undo	Undo a layout mistake
F7	Spell check	Check before a live presentation
Alt + Shift + D	Insert date	Add auto-updated date to slides
Ctrl + Shift + P	Change font size field	Type an exact font size
Ctrl + Enter	Move to next text box	Tab through placeholder boxes
N / Right / Enter	Next slide (in show)	Advance to next slide
P / Left / Backspace	Previous slide (show)	Go back to the previous slide
Number + Enter	Jump to slide N (in show)	Go directly to slide 10

■ **PRO TIP:** During a live presentation press **B** to go black-screen — gives your audience a moment to focus on you.

Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

The shortcuts you'll use every single day across all three applications.

Action	Shortcut	Works In
Save	Ctrl + S	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Undo	Ctrl + Z	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Redo	Ctrl + Y	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Copy	Ctrl + C	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Paste	Ctrl + V	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Cut	Ctrl + X	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Select All	Ctrl + A	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Bold	Ctrl + B	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Italic	Ctrl + I	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Underline	Ctrl + U	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Find	Ctrl + F	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Find & Replace	Ctrl + H	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Print	Ctrl + P	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
New File	Ctrl + N	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Open File	Ctrl + O	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Close File	Ctrl + W	Word · Excel · PowerPoint
Spell Check	F7	Word · PowerPoint
AutoSum	Alt + =	Excel only
Edit Cell	F2	Excel only
Slideshow	F5	PowerPoint only

This guide covers Microsoft Office 365 / Office 2019–2024 on Windows. Mac users: replace Ctrl with **Command** for most shortcuts. Some shortcuts may vary by Office version.